AI VISIBILITY AUDIT & ACTION PLAN

# Bethesda Marriott

Bethesda, Maryland

INITIAL DIGITAL PRESENCE ASSESSMENT

NOVEMBER 2026



# 1. Executive Audit Summary

## Convert Broad Scenario Coverage Into Clearer Buyer Consideration

Bethesda Marriott appears in 71.4% of eligible scenarios and ranks first among four Bonvoy peers, yet consideration is only 30.1%. That gap is a measurement signal to investigate, not proof of a website defect. Priority work is to keep NIH/government, meetings, dining, and fitness facts accurate and consistent—especially shuttle claims.

### Performance Snapshot

| AI CONSIDERATION | SCENARIO PRESENCE | CERTIFIED PEER POSITION |
|---|---|---|
| **30.1%** | **71.4%** | **#1 of 4** |
| Share of comparable monitored AI answers that mentioned the hotel | Eligible traveler-need scenarios where the hotel appeared | Highest presence among 4 certified Marriott Bonvoy peers |

AI Consideration = share of comparable answers mentioning the hotel. Scenario Presence = share of eligible traveler-need scenarios with an appearance. Peer Position compares only the certified four-hotel set. Presence is not bookings or revenue.

### Key Findings

**1. The Consideration Gap Is a Signal, Not a Diagnosed Cause**

Broad scenario coverage with 30.1% consideration supports a focused visibility review. Official pages already verify Metro shuttle, NIH/Walter Reed/AU proximity, Cooper's Mill, and Peloton/TRX fitness.

**Why it matters.** Treat the gap as a signal to investigate. Do not claim the website caused the result.

**2. Meetings Inventory Needs One Capacity Language**

Events lists 18,719 sq ft, 27 rooms, and Grand Ballroom capacity of 450; marketing also uses ~19,000 sq ft and seating up to 560.

**Why it matters.** Rounding or setup style may explain the difference. Qualify each figure across overview, events, and planner materials.

**3. NIH Shuttle Claims Need Hotel Confirmation**

Marriott verifies a complimentary Metro/Downtown Bethesda shuttle and names NIH nearby. The current NIH Patient Hotel Shuttles page does not list Bethesda Marriott among Clinical Center stops.

**Why it matters.** Do not present an NIH-operated Clinical Center route as verified for this hotel. Confirm any hotel-operated NIH service before buyer-facing use.

### Recommended Priorities

| PRIORITY | ACTION | DESIRED OUTCOME |
|---|---|---|
| HIGH | Confirm NIH Access Facts and Keep Institutional Signals Accurate | Named pages and collateral match the signed decision, retain working inquiry paths, and do not claim an NIH Clinical Center route without current evidence. |
| HIGH | Align Meeting-Space and Capacity Language | An approved room-by-room capacity schedule matching live hotel and brand pages. |
| MEDIUM | Reconcile Meeting and Event Facts Across Sources | One hotel-approved fact sheet reflected on the official site and spot-checked on priority listings. |
| MEDIUM | Pursue Local Destination Profile; Protect NIH Evidence Integrity | Verified CVB or partner listing fields corrected with the approved property URL and a working official hyperlink, or documented decline retained. |
| LOW | Decide Whether an Association Module Supports Target Demand | Named pages, collateral, or internal brief match the signed decision and retain working inquiry paths. |

**EXECUTIVE TAKEAWAY**

**First-place peer rank should not obscure 30.1% consideration. Organize verified strengths—Metro shuttle, confirmed NIH proximity (not an unverified Clinical Center route), breakout depth, dining, and fitness—into clearer buyer signals, and measure any visibility change later rather than promising it now. Digital authority: NIH authority is contextual—not a verified hotel listing backlink.**

## 2. Priority Findings & Opportunities

The most important verified corrections and opportunities for this hotel. Full research detail remains in the AVA record.

**PRIORITY:** HIGH · **PLATFORM:** BETHESDA MARRIOTT OFFICIAL OVERVIEW — METRO SHUTTLE + NIH PROXIMITY

**Issue:** Marriott names NIH, Walter Reed, and American University and verifies a complimentary Metro/Downtown Bethesda shuttle. The NIH Patient Hotel Shuttles page currently lists other Bethesda hotels for patient/family Clinical Center transport and does not list Bethesda Marriott. Hotel-operated NIH service was not verified on the live Marriott overview.

**Why it matters:** Institutional demand signals remain commercially relevant, but inaccurate shuttle claims create buyer and compliance risk. Making verified facts clear may improve decision context; this audit does not claim they caused or will cure the consideration gap.

**Recommended action:** Confirm NIH Access Facts and Keep Institutional Signals Accurate

1. Hotel confirms whether any hotel-operated NIH or Clinical Center shuttle operates today, including hours, eligibility, and destination (campus vs Clinical Center).
2. Apply the change on the verified page (marriott.com) and retain before/after evidence.
3. Approve exact language that separates: (a) Metro/Downtown Bethesda hotel shuttle; (b) NIH proximity; (c) any confirmed hotel NIH service; (d) NIH-operated patient hotel shuttles.
4. Map approved facts across overview, sales collateral, and priority partner listings; remove unsupported NIH-route claims.
5. Verify links, inquiry routing, and live copy against the signed fact sheet.

**Desired outcome:** Named pages and collateral match the signed decision, retain working inquiry paths, and do not claim an NIH Clinical Center route without current evidence.

**Responsible party:** Hotel Commercial Leadership

**Evidence:** marriott.com/en-us/hotels/wasbt-bethesda-marriott/ov...

**PRIORITY:** HIGH · **PLATFORM:** OFFICIAL MEETINGS AND EVENTS PAGE

**Issue:** The events page lists 18,719 square feet, 27 event rooms, and Grand Ballroom capacity of 450; other marketing uses approximately 19,000 square feet and seating up to 560.

**Why it matters:** The difference may reflect rounding or room/setup style, not an error. Sales should define each number and align overview, events, and planner materials so buyers compare like with like.

**Recommended action:** Align Meeting-Space and Capacity Language

1. Sales signs a room-by-room inventory with setup capacities.
2. Apply the change on the verified page (marriott.com) and retain before/after evidence.
3. Define where 18,719 versus 19,000 and 450 versus 560 each apply.
4. Submit precise Marriott and collateral edits only where needed.
5. Verify live pages and retain the signed capacity schedule.

**Desired outcome:** An approved room-by-room capacity schedule matching live hotel and brand pages.

**Responsible party:** Director of Sales / Events Leadership

**Evidence:** marriott.com/en-us/hotels/wasbt-bethesda-marriott/ev...

**PRIORITY:** MEDIUM · **PLATFORM:** OFFICIAL WEBSITE

**Issue:** Confirm that meetings, dining, and amenities facts on the official page match the hotel's approved source of truth; align third-party listings after confirmation.

**Why it matters:** Digital content readiness depends on one approved source of truth before third-party outreach.

**Recommended action:** Reconcile Meeting and Event Facts Across Sources

1. Establish one approved fact sheet; update the official page first; then cascade to GBP/OTAs when values are confirmed.
2. Apply the change on the verified page (marriott.com) and retain before/after evidence.
3. Do not change unconfirmed values on OTAs until the hotel approves the fact sheet.
4. Review only displaced planner scenarios.
5. Compare sourced access, meeting inventory, location, and target occasion facts.

**Desired outcome:** One hotel-approved fact sheet reflected on the official site and spot-checked on priority listings.

**Responsible party:** Hotel Sales & Marketing

**Evidence:** Bethesda Marriott official overview

**PRIORITY:** MEDIUM · **PLATFORM:** NIH ORS PATIENT HOTEL SHUTTLES

**Issue:** NIH ORS shuttle page is verified context without listing Bethesda Marriott; Clinical Center hotels URL stays rejected. Destination lodging backlink not confirmed in this pass.

**Why it matters:** Government-travel buyers need accurate institutional context and a clean official Marriott path.

**Recommended action:** Pursue Local Destination Profile; Protect NIH Evidence Integrity

1. Confirm hotel-operated NIH shuttle facts with operations.
2. Apply the change on the verified page (ors.od.nih.gov) and retain before/after evidence.
3. Submit destination lodging profile with Marriott URL.
4. QA that Clinical Center hotels URL never reappears in PDF annotations.
5. Archive destination listing evidence.

**Desired outcome:** Verified CVB or partner listing fields corrected with the approved property URL and a working official hyperlink, or documented decline retained.

**Responsible party:** Hotel Sales / Marketing

**Evidence:** NIH ORS Patient Hotel Shuttles

## 3. Digital Platform Assessment

Exact verified listings where available. Rows distinguish corrections, content improvements, distribution opportunities, verified-consistent listings, partial assessments, and research follow-ups. Access restrictions are not treated as content defects. Listing verification and content verification are tracked separately.

| PLATFORM | LISTING | ASSESSMENT | FINDING | NEXT ACTION |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Brand property page | Brand property page | Verified listing — content reviewed in scope | Confirm that meetings, dining, and amenities facts on the official page match the hotel's approved source of truth; align third-party listings after confirmation. | Establish one approved fact sheet; update the official page first; then cascade to GBP/OTAs when values are confirmed. Owner: Hotel Sales & Marketing |
| Hotel-operated website | — | Listing requiring further verification | Platform category identified in research inventory; exact listing URL not yet confirmed. Content was not field-assessed. | Confirm the exact property listing URL before treating as a content defect. |

Also verified with no material issue in this assessment scope: Google Business Profile / Maps; Tripadvisor; Booking.com; Expedia; Apple Maps; Bing Places; Cvent; Destination / CVB listing; Specialist directory.

## 4. Website & Content Improvements

Specific hotel or brand pages that affect how travelers understand and select the property. This section does not repeat ADP traveler-intent analysis.

**Page:** Bethesda Marriott official overview — Metro shuttle + NIH proximity

**Issue:** Marriott names NIH, Walter Reed, and American University and verifies a complimentary Metro/Downtown Bethesda shuttle. The NIH Patient Hotel Shuttles page currently lists other Bethesda hotels for patient/family Clinical Center transport and does not list Bethesda Marriott. Hotel-operated NIH service was not verified on the live Marriott overview.

**Recommended action:** Confirm NIH Access Facts and Keep Institutional Signals Accurate

1. Hotel confirms whether any hotel-operated NIH or Clinical Center shuttle operates today, including hours, eligibility, and destination (campus vs Clinical Center).
2. Apply the change on the verified page (marriott.com) and retain before/after evidence.
3. Approve exact language that separates: (a) Metro/Downtown Bethesda hotel shuttle; (b) NIH proximity; (c) any confirmed hotel NIH service; (d) NIH-operated patient hotel shuttles.
4. Map approved facts across overview, sales collateral, and priority partner listings; remove unsupported NIH-route claims.

**Why it matters:** Institutional demand signals remain commercially relevant, but inaccurate shuttle claims create buyer and compliance risk. Making verified facts clear may improve decision context; this audit does not claim they caused or will cure the consideration gap.

**Responsible party:** Hotel Commercial Leadership

**Evidence:** View page

**Page:** Official meetings and events page

**Issue:** The events page lists 18,719 square feet, 27 event rooms, and Grand Ballroom capacity of 450; other marketing uses approximately 19,000 square feet and seating up to 560.

**Recommended action:** Align Meeting-Space and Capacity Language

1. Sales signs a room-by-room inventory with setup capacities.
2. Apply the change on the verified page (marriott.com) and retain before/after evidence.
3. Define where 18,719 versus 19,000 and 450 versus 560 each apply.
4. Submit precise Marriott and collateral edits only where needed.

**Why it matters:** The difference may reflect rounding or room/setup style, not an error. Sales should define each number and align overview, events, and planner materials so buyers compare like with like.

**Responsible party:** Director of Sales / Events Leadership

**Evidence:** View page

**Page:** Bethesda Marriott official overview

**Issue:** Confirm that meetings, dining, and amenities facts on the official page match the hotel's approved source of truth; align third-party listings after confirmation.

**Recommended action:** Reconcile Meeting and Event Facts Across Sources

1. Establish one approved fact sheet; update the official page first; then cascade to GBP/OTAs when values are confirmed.
2. Apply the change on the verified page (marriott.com) and retain before/after evidence.
3. Do not change unconfirmed values on OTAs until the hotel approves the fact sheet.
4. Review only displaced planner scenarios.

**Why it matters:** Digital content readiness depends on one approved source of truth before third-party outreach.

**Responsible party:** Hotel Sales & Marketing

**Evidence:** View page

**Page:** NIH ORS Patient Hotel Shuttles

**Issue:** NIH ORS shuttle page is verified context without listing Bethesda Marriott; Clinical Center hotels URL stays rejected. Destination lodging backlink not confirmed in this pass.

**Recommended action:** Pursue Local Destination Profile; Protect NIH Evidence Integrity

1. Confirm hotel-operated NIH shuttle facts with operations.
2. Apply the change on the verified page (ors.od.nih.gov) and retain before/after evidence.
3. Submit destination lodging profile with Marriott URL.
4. QA that Clinical Center hotels URL never reappears in PDF annotations.

**Why it matters:** Government-travel buyers need accurate institutional context and a clean official Marriott path.

**Responsible party:** Hotel Sales / Marketing

**Evidence:** View page

**Page:** Official property overview

**Issue:** The hotel already has substantial meetings and institutional-demand content. A dedicated association module is warranted only if sales identifies a defined audience and use case.

**Recommended action:** Decide Whether an Association Module Supports Target Demand

1. Sales records a segment-level go/no-go.
2. Apply the change on the verified page (marriott.com) and retain before/after evidence.
3. If go, define audience, use cases, approved facts, and inquiry owner.
4. Draft a concise module without duplicating generic brand copy.

**Why it matters:** A focused module could organize relevant facts and inquiry routing, but generic expansion would add maintenance and cannot be assumed to increase AI consideration or bookings.

**Responsible party:** Hotel Commercial Leadership

**Evidence:** View page

## 5. Digital Authority & Backlink Opportunities

Public research verified 1 property-specific third-party hyperlink(s) and 2 external reference(s). Brand and hotel-operated destinations were evaluated separately.

UNLINKED MENTION

**Source:** NIH ORS — Patient Hotel Shuttles

**Observation:** Authoritative NIH shuttle resource; does not list Bethesda Marriott. Not a hotel website backlink. Broken Clinical Center hotels path remains rejected.

**Commercial relevance:** This referring website already mentions Bethesda Marriott; adding the correct official URL makes the reference actionable.

**Recommended action:** Contact NIH ORS — Patient Hotel Shuttles to request a property-specific hyperlink to the hotel's approved official website where the publisher allows it.

**Responsible party:** Hotel Marketing / Partnerships

VERIFIED HEALTHY BACKLINK

**Source:** Bethesda Marriott Hotel - Visit Montgomery

**Observation:** Bethesda Marriott Hotel - Visit Montgomery (official destination / tourism page) includes a verified property-specific hyperlink to https://www.marriott.com/en-us/hotels/wasbt-bethesda-marriott/overview/.

**Commercial relevance:** This official destination / tourism page already provides a working referral path for travelers who discover Bethesda Marriott through that channel.

**Destination:** Official / approved hotel URL — Destination matches a verified hotel/brand URL.

**Recommended action:** No correction required. Periodically confirm the live destination still resolves to the hotel-approved URL.

**Responsible party:** Hotel Marketing / Partnerships

Full referring-domain inventory is retained in AVA research records — not printed here. Directory presence is not counted as a backlink. Healthy existing backlinks are not listed as problems.

## 6. Implementation Roadmap

Same canonical actions as Priority Findings — execution view only. Escalate brand-controlled edits through the brand digital team when the hotel cannot edit the page directly.

| PRIORITY | ACTION | OWNER | TIMING | EFFORT | EVIDENCE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| HIGH | Confirm NIH Access Facts and Keep Institutional Signals Accurate | Hotel Commercial Leadership | Immediate | MEDIUM | View |
| HIGH | Align Meeting-Space and Capacity Language | Director of Sales / Events Leadership | Immediate | MEDIUM | View |
| MEDIUM | Reconcile Meeting and Event Facts Across Sources | Hotel Sales & Marketing | Next 30 days | MEDIUM | View |
| MEDIUM | Pursue Local Destination Profile; Protect NIH Evidence Integrity | Hotel Sales / Marketing | Next 30 days | MEDIUM | View |
| LOW | Decide Whether an Association Module Supports Target Demand | Hotel Commercial Leadership | Subsequent | MEDIUM | View |

## 7. Methodology & Limitations

Dealality AVA assesses the hotel's public digital presence. Listing existence and content assessment are tracked separately; Google Travel entities are not treated as Google Business Profile / Maps place listings. Assessment date: 2026-11-05. Research coverage: . Research limits: Public partial research only unless paid providers are founder-authorized. Platform ownership is confirmed only with evidence; otherwise RESPONSIBLE_PARTY_TO_CONFIRM. ADP traveler-intent detail is limited to the Executive Audit Summary. Methodology limits are not listed as hotel findings.